DEVELOPER RELATIONS ENGINEER APPLICATION

Adyen Developer Relations: making the platform agent-ready in 90 days

Matthew Karsten · September 2026

Built for this application: an agent-legibility audit of docs.adyen.com and an MCP server for the Checkout TEST API.
github.com/ExpertVagabond/adyen-agent-ready

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THE MISSION, IN ADYEN'S WORDS

Easiest platform to integrate with, for humans and agents alike

> "We own the quality of the developer-facing content that people and agents build from ... and we're making Adyen's developer surfaces agent-legible and agent-reliable as an explicit quality bar."
>
> Developer Relations Engineer posting, Greenhouse job 8018245

> "Keeping it current is part of the job, because stale content misleads agents as much as people."
>
> Same posting

That is a measurable bar. So I measured it.

WHAT I BUILT FOR THIS APPLICATION

adyen-agent-ready: an audit tool and an MCP server

The audit reads Adyen's surfaces the way an agent does: plain HTTP, Markdown, no JavaScript.

- Every page in `llms.txt` (2,524), `llms-full.txt`, sitemap, `robots.txt`
- 19,084 code blocks linted: JSON, JS, TS, Python
- Docs diffed against `CheckoutService-v72.json`
- 17 numbered findings, each with URLs and counts

The MCP server covers what the official one does not, on the official Node SDK.

- `/paymentMethods`, `/sessions`, `/payments`, `/payments/details`
- 92-card test catalogue parsed from the docs
- Docs lookup with a token budget; audit findings as a tool
- 31 tests, HTTP mocked at the SDK seam; TEST only by default

The door is open. The room is hard to read.

HTTP 429

Cloudflare JavaScript challenge served to a plain HTTP client on `.md` URLs after about 1,000 fetches. No Retry-After.

51.1 MB

`llms-full.txt`, about 13.4M tokens. No model can load the file `llms.txt` calls "the full corpus".

0 of 29

Checkout operations with a Markdown reference in `llms.txt`. Guides link to the JS-only API Explorer 11,370 times.

847 / 7,870

snippets that do not parse even as fragments. 299 JSON examples contain `...`; 526 more need dedent or wrapping.

245 pages

mix Checkout API versions in their own examples. The Sessions flow guide calls v70, v71 and v72 on one page.

115 pages

leak `{hint:...}{/hint}` template markup, 66 times inside JSON, five times as a JSON key.

Full list with URLs: AUDIT.md in the repo

THE AGENT-READY FIX

Serve agents what the robots file promises them

- **Open the door.** Exempt `/*.md`, `llms.txt` and `llms-full.txt` from the managed challenge, or return a real 429 with `Retry-After`.
- **Index the reference.** One Markdown page per operation, generated from the OpenAPI spec, under `## API reference` in `llms.txt`. The repo ships the Checkout v72 version today.
- **Right-size the corpus.** Split `llms-full.txt` per product; one `.md` per language tab, so the Sessions guide is 15k tokens for a Node developer, not 156k.
- **Make examples executable.** Lint every snippet in CI, validate request examples against the schema, template the API version from one constant, strip `{hint:}` in the Markdown export.

All of it is CI and a renderer change. None of it needs a budget, a reorg, or a new product.

30 / 60 / 90

Three milestones, each shipped, measured, reported

Days 1 to 30: the seams

- Challenge exemption for agent paths
- Audit as a docs CI job
- `{hint:}` leak fixed: 115 to 0
- Version drift: 245 to 0

Days 31 to 60: the reference

- 29 Checkout operations in `llms.txt`
- `llms-full.txt` split per product
- One `.md` per language tab
- Snippet pass rate 89% to 99%+

Days 61 to 90: the loop

- Official MCP generated from the spec, 29 of 29
- Agent task-success benchmark, monthly
- Monthly DX report to Product, by URL
- 172 stale integration pages reviewed

METRICS I WOULD REPORT

Numbers that go to zero and stay there

METRIC	TODAY	DAY 90
Agent fetch success, full crawl at any polite rate	40% at 12 workers	100%
Snippet pass rate (JSON/JS/TS/Python)	89.2%	99%+
Pages mixing Checkout versions / without v72	245 / 67	0 / 0
Checkout operations with a Markdown reference in llms.txt	0 of 29	29 of 29
Pages with leaked template markup	115	0
Agent task-success on 20 real integration questions	baseline month 1	90%
Stale integration pages with code, unreviewed	172	0

Every number is computable from artifacts Adyen already publishes

WHY ME

I have done this job in the agent era

10,000+

active developers on a platform whose docs, SDKs, starter kits and reference apps I owned as Developer Relations Engineer at ZetaChain

15+

production MCP servers shipped, including a 65+ tool server for ZetaChain, a 73-tool Hedera server, and a Solana server used by 1,000+ developers

50,000+

concurrent users on a streaming backend I architected for DirecTV LATAM, AT&T and IBM; 100+ Cloudflare production deployments

3 books, 3 stages

3 published technical books; talks at EthCC 2025, ETH NYC and ETH Denver. Claude Certified Architect, Anthropic 2026. B.F.A., Point Park University.

Relocating to San Francisco. Office-first suits how I work.

LINKS

Everything here is public and re-runnable

- Repo, audit and MCP server: **github.com/ExpertVagabond/adyen-agent-ready**
- Audit report with URLs for every finding: **AUDIT.md** in the repo (`npm run audit` to refresh)
- Generated Checkout v72 Markdown reference: **data/llms-checkout.txt**
- Other public work: github.com/ExpertVagabond/hedera-mcp · github.com/ExpertVagabond
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